



Resident Evil 5



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Resident Evil 5 is an embarrassment to the survival horror genre. First of all, the environments are not cramped, secondly, a majority of the game takes place during the day and finally it doesn't try to force you to memorise a brand new control scheme to (artificially) heighten the tension. If this is what survival horror meant to you, kindly stop reading this review but if you're willing to accept change you'd realise that Capcom's bold decisions have led to a game that is bound to please the survival horror enthusiast and the newbie alike.

Earlier *Resident Evil* games were criticised for their clunky control scheme, unforgiving save system (which required you to hunt down typewriters in in-game locations) and steep learning curve. It seems that Capcom have taken their community feedback to heart this time around. While last generation's *Resident Evil 4* was a step up from the series' usual offering, *Resident Evil 5* builds upon its over the shoulder action, quick time events and visceral bloody boss

battles to deliver a game that is a revolution, if not evolution of the franchise.

This time around you'd be visiting the fictitious African country of Kijuju as Chris Redfield, the protagonist of the first game *Resident Evil* that literally invented the survival horror genre. Along the way you'd encounter foes and faces, familiar and new in addition to the usual convoluted to the point of nonsensical plot that usually accompanies each installment in the series. And to share all this newness (and familiarity) with you is Sheva Alomar, your partner for the mission, who is playable in co-operative mode. While most team-based characters are a pain to manage when controlled by the AI, Sheva is different. She provides you cover fire, ammo and makes the single player experience quite enjoyable. A definite step up from team members of other titles such as *Army of Two* and *Gears of War*.

While we're on the topic of *Gears of War*, if you've played the game, or any other third-person shooter, you'd be right at home with the controls in *Resident Evil 5*. The control scheme marries the best of contemporary games with the longstanding *Resident Evil*

